

Psychodynamic Therapy

Assumption	Description
Assumption of psychological causation	<i>Problems brought</i> to psychotherapy can be discussed in terms of thoughts and feelings. Mental disorders are conceptualised as organisations of conscious or unconscious beliefs, thoughts, and feelings.
<i>Assumption of limitations of consciousness and the influence of unconscious mental states</i>	<i>Understanding</i> conscious experiences requires referring to unaware mental states, often motivated by a desire for safety. Helping patients become aware of unconscious expectations can aid in gaining control of emotions and behaviour.
<i>Assumption of internal representations of interpersonal relationships</i>	<i>Interpersonal</i> relationships, especially attachment relationships, are central to personality organisation. Mental representations of these relationships form schematic mental structures that shape interpersonal expectations and self-representations.
<i>Assumption of ubiquity of psychological conflict</i>	<i>Wishes, affects, and ideas</i> can be in conflict, causing distress and potentially undermining the development of psychological capacities.
<i>Assumption of psychic defences</i>	<i>Defences are</i> mental operations that distort conscious mental states to reduce anxiety. Self-serving distortions of mental states are a common feature of human information processing.
<i>Assumption of complex meanings</i>	<i>Behaviour</i> can be understood in terms of underlying mental states that may not be explicit in action or awareness. Different psychodynamic orientations may identify different concealed meanings behind the same behaviours.
<i>Assumption of emphasis on the therapeutic relationship</i>	<i>Establishing</i> an attachment relationship with a clinician is helpful. Different therapeutic schools explain this differently, but converging theorisation and research data suggest that engagement with an understanding adult triggers human capacities for relatedness that are therapeutic.
<i>Assumption of the validity of a developmental perspective</i>	Psychodynamic psychotherapists are oriented to the developmental aspects of their patients' problems and work to optimise developmental processes.

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Freudian psychoanalysis

Sigmund Freud's psychoanalytic theory, which emphasises the influence of childhood experiences on adult psychopathology, has been influential in the field of psychology. While later psychoanalytic theories have built upon and sometimes diverged from Freud's ideas, the developmental perspective remains a core aspect of psychodynamic psychotherapy. Despite criticisms of its emphasis on early childhood and the challenges of empirical validation, the developmental model continues to be a valuable framework for understanding psychological disturbance.

Structural Approach

Theorist	Key Contributions	Concepts
Heinz Hartmann	Proposed the key developmental assumption of <i>change of function</i>.	Secondary <i>autonomy</i>, ego's undifferentiated origin
Erik Erikson	Focused on the interaction of social norms and biological drives in generating self and identity.	Eight developmental stages, identity <i>diffusion</i>, basic trust vs. basic mistrust
René Spitz	Ascribed primary importance to the mother-infant interaction.	Organisers, shifts in psychological organisation
Edith Jacobson	Assumed a state of primitive fusion between early object representations and self-representation.	Primitive fusion
Hans Loewald	Proposed that <i>integrative experience</i> is at the centre of development.	Internalisation, relationality, interactional and intersubjective experiences

The structural approach in psychoanalysis, criticised for its quasi-physiological character and emphasis on sexuality, has been reinterpreted and adapted over time. While some analysts remain committed to updated structural models, others have embraced object relations theory or developed alternative models like relational theory and self-psychology. Despite criticisms, the structural approach's influence persists in developmental theories and recent research linking anxiety, craving, and dreaming to instinctual drive states.

Anna Freud

Aspect of Theory	Description	Examples
Developmental Model	Emphasises developmental progress through resolving conflicts.	Child finding a compromise among wishes, needs, perceptions, etc.
Role of Drives	Maintains Freudian view that drives are crucial in	N/A

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	ego and superego formation.	
Influence of Child-Rearing	Acknowledges the impact of child-rearing on ego and superego development.	N/A
Developmental Lines	Metaphor for continuous and cumulative child development.	Dependency to emotional self-reliance, egocentrism to social partnerships, etc.
Pathology	Defined as discrepancies or lags in developmental lines.	Arrest or regression along a developmental line
Specific Issues	Identified disturbances in narcissism, object relatedness, aggression control, etc.	N/A
Anxiety	Distinguished between <i>objective anxiety</i> (fear of external world) and internal anxiety (fear of impulses, wishes, feelings).	N/A
Empirical Support	Her work with infants at Hampstead war nurseries supported her theories.	Study on children's reactions to Scud missile attacks in Israel

Margaret Mahler

Subphase	Age	Description
Normal Autism	First weeks of life	State of undifferentiation between the infant and the mother.
Symbiotic Phase	Around 2-4 months	Infant experiences a <i>sense</i> of unity with the mother.
Differentiation	Around 4-9 months	Infant begins to distinguish themselves from the mother.
Practicing	9-15-18 months	Infant explores their own autonomy and independence.
Rapprochement	Second half of the second year	Infant seeks closeness and reunion with the mother.
Consolidation of Individuality	Beginning of the third year	Infant solidifies their sense of self and individuality.

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Joseph Sandler

Concept	Description
Integration of Psychoanalysis	Modernised psychoanalysis for integration with developmental sciences.
Common Ground	Found common ground between American ego psychology and British object relations theory.
Representational World	Introduced the concept of the representational world, similar to schema theory.
Motivation	Placed feeling states at the centre of motivation, rather than psychic energy.
Background of Safety	Introduced the concept of <i>background of safety</i> , where the ego aims to maximise safety.
Drives	Explained the influence of drives on behaviour through their impact on feelings.
Patient-Therapist Relationships	Suggested that patients create relationships to actualize unconscious fantasies.
Internal Object Representations	Differentiated between past unconscious (hypothetical structures) and present unconscious (works irrationally, concerned with current experience).
Developmental Model of Depression	Proposed a developmental model of depression based on the representational world construct.
Projective Identification	Explained projective identification without extravagant assumptions.
Therapeutic Phenomena	His models explain therapeutic phenomena like countertransference.
Influence	His theories are widely used but not always attributed to him.

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Object Relation Theory

Category	Description	Key Figures	Examples
Hard Object Relations Theories	Derive relationships from drive theory; emphasise the individual's experience of being with others, including the therapist.	Melanie Klein, Ronald Fairbairn, Otto Kernberg	Klein's work on the depressive position and paranoid-schizoid position
Soft Object Relations Theories	Derive drives from object relations; focus on the individual's experience of being with others, including the therapist.	Michael Balint, D. W. Winnicott, Heinz Kohut	Bion's work on emotional development and pathology

Concept	Description	Controversy
Projective Identification	An interpersonal process where the self gets rid of feelings by evoking the same feelings in another self.	Characterised as a defensive mechanism by some.
Infancy Roots of Projective Identification	Process originates in infancy.	Debate over the extent to which infants possess complex psychological capacities.
Innate Violent Tendencies	Klein suggested that children innately possess ruthless and sadistic fantasies.	Controversial claim that violent tendencies are innate rather than caused by environmental influences.
Mediation of Genetic Vulnerability	Model has been influential in understanding how genetic vulnerability is mediated.	Supported by evidence of physical aggression and destructiveness in early childhood.
Paranoid-Schizoid Position	A predominance of this position leads to mental disorder.	N/A
Depressive Position	Relative stability of this position reflects mental health.	Bion argued that the depressive position is never permanently achieved.
Psychotic States	Intense annihilatory/persecutory anxieties lead to projective identification and reintrojection.	Delusions of external control over the mind or body.
Neurotic Problems	Consequences of unresolved depressive anxiety.	N/A
Depression	Arises from the experience of loss,	Chronic depression occurs when the person cannot

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	reminding the person of the damage caused to the good object.	escape the fear of injuring the loved object.
Narcissistic Character Structure	A defence against envy and dependence.	Characterised by ruthless use of others and a professed lack of need for them.
Evidence for Early Origins of Mental Disorders	Evidence suggests that most adult mental disorders are foreshadowed in infancy.	Debate over the interpretation of psychoanalytic infant observation.
Early Brain Development	Increasingly seen as pivotal in the development of mental disorders.	N/A

HEINZ KOHUT AND SELF PSYCHOLOGY

Concept	Description
Narcissistic Development	Proceeds along a unique path, with parents serving as selfobjects.
Empathic Responses	Allow the unfolding of exhibitionism and grandiosity from the mirroring selfobject.
Frustration	Promotes the modulation of infantile omnipotence through the <i>transmuting internalisation</i> of the mirroring selfobject.
Consolidation of the Nuclear Self	Occurs gradually through the transmuting internalisation of the mirroring selfobject.
Idealisation of Selfobjects	Leads to the development of ideals through internalisation.

Concept	Description	Criticism
Cohesive Self	Goal to be attained, a self that remains constant over time.	May overlook the <i>natural evolution</i> of the self over time.
Enfeebled Self	Result of inadequate emotional attunement from selfobjects, leading to defensive pleasure-seeking behaviours.	Could be seen as overly simplistic in explaining complex psychological phenomena.
Anxiety	Primarily experienced as a defect or lack of continuity in the self.	May neglect other potential sources of anxiety.
Deficiency-Based Theory	Assumes that a lack of facilitating experiences leads to a primary psychic deficit, an inadequately developed self.	Criticised as parent blaming and overemphasising environmental influences.
Psychosis	Characterised by a complete lack of a cohesive sense of self.	N/A

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Personality Disorders	Enfeebled self vulnerable to temporary fragmentation.	May oversimplify the complexities of personality disorders.
Neurosis	Associated with a robust self structure.	May overlook other potential underlying causes of neurosis.
Narcissistic Personality	Developmental arrest at the grandiose exhibitionistic self stage due to inadequate mirroring from parents.	Criticised for being overly deterministic and neglecting genetic influences.
Borderline Personality	Inability to psychologically hold on to selfobjects that could be soothing.	May oversimplify the complexities of borderline personality disorder.
Drug Addiction	Seen as a way to fill a missing gap in the psyche.	May be seen as an overly simplistic explanation of addiction.
Mirror Neurons	Brain cells activated when an individual observes a movement analogous to its own.	Somewhat far-fetched to consider it a direct confirmation of self psychological ideas.
Genetic Influences	Increasing evidence of genetically rooted personality traits.	Challenges the notion of primarily environmental influences on development.
Passive Genotype-Environment Correlation	Child's genetically rooted characteristics can shape the family <i>environment</i>.	Challenges the idea of a direct causal relationship between parenting style and child behaviour.
Child-to-Parent Effect	Child's genetically rooted characteristics can influence the family environment.	Challenges the notion of a primarily environmental impact on development.
Family Environment Moderating Genetic Influence	Qualities of the family environment can influence the expression of genetic predispositions.	Supports the idea of a complex interplay between genetics and environment.

STRUCTURAL OBJECT RELATIONS: OTTO KERNBERG

Otto Kernberg's structural object relations theory, a synthesis of the Klein-Bion model and modern structural theory, emphasises the role of affects in the motivational system. Kernberg's approach to neurotic problems focuses on the patient's current thinking and utilises psychiatric diagnostic categories to predict treatment response. His work on personality disorders, particularly borderline personality disorder, highlights the importance of ego structures and aggressive impulses, and his transference-focused psychotherapy has shown efficacy in treating these disorders.

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THE INTERPERSONAL RELATIONAL APPROACH

Approach	Description	Key Concepts
1. Nonreflective, presymbolic behaviour	Organises relational fields around reciprocal influences and mutual regulation	Reciprocal influences, mutual regulation
2. Affective permeability	Shared experience of intense affect across permeable boundaries	Direct resonances, interpersonal dyads
3. Self-other configurations	Organisation of experience into self-other configurations	Self-other configurations
4. Intersubjectivity	Mutual recognition of self-reflective agents	Mutual recognition, self-reflective agents

Approach	Evidence Base	Notes
Interpersonal Therapy (IPT)	Strong evidence for depression in adults; some evidence for adolescents	May have deviated from its psychodynamic roots
Psychoanalytic Adaptations	Controlled studies show effectiveness for mood disorders and eating disorders	Retain a focus on the relationship-seeking aspect of human character

Schema Theory

Theorist(s)	Integration Approach	Key Concepts	Applications
Boesky (1988), Peterfreund (1971), Rosenblatt and Thickstun (1977)	Psychoanalysis and Systems Theory	Unconscious relationship procedures	Psychotherapy based on describing unconscious processes
Horowitz et al. (1995)	British Object Relations Theory, Cognitive Science, and Systems Theory	Person schemas	Cognitive analytic therapy addressing underlying relationship patterns
Anthony Ryle	Psychoanalysis and Systems Theory	Reciprocal role procedures (care, dependency, control, submission, love, anger)	Therapist-patient correspondence in cognitive analytic therapy
Daniel Stern	Psychoanalysis and Systems Theory	Self development phases (<i>emerging, core, subjective, narrative</i>)	Development of personality disorders and neurosis
Stern	Psychoanalysis and Systems Theory	Emergent <i>moments</i>, schematic representations, <i>feeling shapes</i>, <i>pronarrative envelopes</i>	Distortions in basic schemas leading to psychopathology

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Mentalization Theory

<i>Process</i>	<i>Description</i>	<i>Potential Outcome of Disruption</i>
Labelling and understanding of affect	Identifying and comprehending emotions	Difficulty in emotional regulation and expression
Arousal regulation	Managing emotional arousal and reactivity	Difficulty in self-soothing and emotional control
Effortful control	Regulating impulses and behaviour	Impulsivity and difficulty in goal-directed behaviour
Mentalizing/Mind-reading capacities	Understanding and inferring mental states of oneself and others	Difficulty in social cognition and empathy

Area	Description	Consequences
Agentive Self	Dysfunctions in the agentive self are central to psychopathology.	Severe personality disorder or borderline personality organisation
Interpersonal Interpretive Function	Dysfunctions in this function lead to problems with understanding others.	Disorganised attachment and disorganisation of the self
Attachment System	Disorganised attachment results from incongruent mirroring and insecure base.	Alien self formation, where ideas/feelings are experienced as not belonging to the self
Trauma Impact	Trauma exacerbates vulnerabilities in individuals with insecure early environments.	Inhibited playfulness, impaired affect regulation, attentional control difficulties, and potential failure of mentalization
Treatment Approach	Stable, coherent representation of the patient's internal world is proposed.	Randomised controlled trial showed promising results in partial hospital setting

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